Paw & Prosper

FOR VETS, GROOMERS, BOARDING AND DAYCARE, TRAINERS, PET BRANDS AND RESCUES

Is AI Recommending Your Pet Business?

The Unmissable Checklist

20 checks, about 20 minutes, one score out of 100 that shows whether Google, ChatGPT and other AI tools can find, understand and trust your pet business.

- ✓ Find out if ChatGPT, Gemini and Perplexity name you when customers ask
- ✓ Copy-paste test prompts, no tools or logins to buy
- ✓ See exactly what to fix first, in plain language

20	20	20	40
Technical Foundation	Authority Engine	AI & Search Optimization	Local & Trust Signals

My score: _ _ _ _ / 100

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How to score yourself

Work through the 20 checks with your website and phone open. Each one takes under 2 minutes. Give yourself 5, 2 or 0 points, add them up, and you'll know exactly where you stand and what to fix first.

1

Open three things. Your website, your Google Business Profile, and an AI assistant or two (ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity, or whichever your customers use).

2

Run each test. Copy the prompts exactly, swapping in your details where you see CAPS like YOUR TOWN (YOURDOMAIN means your web address, without the https://). Use a private window if you can.

3

Score honestly. Not sure? Score it 0. A low score now just means bigger, faster wins later.

The scoring

Yes = 5
You fully match “Good looks like.”

Partly = 2
You match some of it.

No = 0
You don't, or you're not sure.

The four pillars

These 20 checks are a simplified, do-it-yourself version of the Unmissable Index, the four-pillar scoring framework I use in every paid audit. Technical Foundation, Authority Engine and AI & Search Optimization are worth 20 points each. Local & Trust Signals is worth 40, because for a local business, trust is what gets you chosen.

Tips for accurate results

- AI answers change from one ask to the next. Ask each prompt twice and score what you see most often.
- Search from your phone, near your business, for the map checks. Results depend on where the searcher stands.
- Write down every competitor AI or Google shows instead of you. That list is gold.

45% of consumers used ChatGPT or another AI tool for local business recommendations, up from 6% the year before.

BrightLocal, Local Consumer Review Survey 2026

Prefer to have AI walk you through it?

Upload this PDF to ChatGPT or Claude and paste:

> **I'm attaching a 20-point AI visibility checklist. Walk me through it one check at a time for my business, YOUR BUSINESS NAME in YOUR TOWN (website: YOURDOMAIN). For each check, tell me exactly what to test, wait for my answer, then score it Yes (5), Partly (2) or No (0) and tell me the fix. At the end, add up my score out of 100 and list my top 3 fixes.**

One catch: run checks 9 and 10 in a separate, fresh private chat. An assistant that already knows your business can't show you what a stranger would see.

PILLAR 1 OF 4

Technical Foundation

Can Google and AI tools reach and read your website? 20 points

1 Your site loads fast on a phone

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Most people find you on their phone. Slow pages lose them before they ever see your services.

TEST IT: Go to **pagespeed.web.dev**, paste your homepage address, and look at the **Mobile** result. Then open your site on your own phone with Wi-Fi off.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
A Performance score of 50 or higher (orange or green), and your page shows real content within about 3 seconds on your phone.

THE FIX
Shrink large photos (under 300 KB each is a good target), remove pop-ups and plugins you don't use, and turn on image optimization in your website builder.

2 Google has your important pages

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

If Google hasn't indexed a page, neither Google Search nor its AI answers can show it.

TEST IT: Search Google for **site:YOURDOMAIN**. Then search **site:YOURDOMAIN YOUR MAIN SERVICE**.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Your homepage, every main service page, and your contact or booking page all show up.

THE FIX
Set up Google Search Console (free), submit your sitemap, and use URL Inspection to request indexing for any page that's missing.

Google: to show up in AI Overviews and AI Mode, a page must be "indexed and eligible to be shown in Google Search with a snippet."

3 Your site tells machines who you are

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Schema markup is a hidden label on your site that spells out your business type, address, phone and hours for search engines.

TEST IT: Go to **validator.schema.org** (or Google's Rich Results Test), paste your homepage, and run it.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
It finds a business type such as LocalBusiness, VeterinaryCare, PetStore or AnimalShelter, with your real name, address, phone and hours, matching what the page says.

THE FIX
Most website builders have a business info setting or a schema plugin. Fill it in once and check it again with the validator.

Google says no special schema is required for its AI features. I still count it: it's cheap, it lasts, and it helps every search engine read you correctly. Better to have it and not need it.

4 AI tools are allowed to read your site

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

A file called robots.txt can quietly block the crawlers AI search tools use to read your site.

TEST IT: Visit **YOURDOMAIN/robots.txt**. Look for **Disallow: /** under **User-agent: *** or under a search crawler such as OAI-SearchBot (ChatGPT search), PerplexityBot or Bingbot. If you use Cloudflare, check whether its AI bot blocking setting is on.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
No search crawler is blocked from your whole site. Crawler names change over time; the rule doesn't: let search crawlers in.

THE FIX
Remove the block, or ask whoever manages your website. You can still block training-only crawlers (like GPTBot) if you prefer.

OpenAI recommends allowing OAI-SearchBot so your site can appear in ChatGPT search results, and says blocking GPTBot (training) is a separate choice.

PILLAR 2 OF 4

Authority Engine

Does your website prove you know your stuff? 20 points

5 Every main service has its own page

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

One “Services” page with a bullet list gives Google and AI nothing specific to match or quote.

TEST IT: Write down your top 3 money-makers (for example dental cleanings, puppy classes, overnight boarding or a full groom). Search **site:YOURDOMAIN SERVICE NAME** for each.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Each one has its own page with the service in the title, what's included, who it's for, a price or “starting at,” and a booking button.

THE FIX
Start with your most profitable service. 400 to 800 words in your own voice is plenty.

Whitespark's 2026 expert survey ranks “Dedicated Page for Each Service” the #2 factor for AI search visibility.

6 You have helpful guides, not just sales pages

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

AI tools recommend the businesses that explain things well. Guides show you're the expert.

TEST IT: Look at your blog, resources or tips pages. Count the pages that teach something a customer cares about.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
At least 3 pages that answer a real question in depth, such as “What to pack for your dog's first boarding stay” or “How often should a doodle be groomed?”

THE FIX
Pick the question you answer most often by phone or email and write the answer once, properly. Then do one a month.

7 Something new or updated in the last 90 days

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Fresh, accurate pages tell people and machines you're open, active and current.

TEST IT: Find the newest date on your blog or news page. Then scan your homepage and service pages for anything stale: old prices, old hours, staff who left, last year's specials.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Something meaningful was published or updated in the last 90 days, and nothing on the site is out of date.

THE FIX
Put a 30-minute monthly reminder on your calendar: publish or update one page, and fix anything stale.

8 Your pages link to each other and to booking

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Links between your pages help Google find everything and help visitors take the next step.

TEST IT: Open your 3 main service pages. Look for a booking or contact button and for links to related pages.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Every service page links to booking and to at least one related page (a guide or FAQ), and your homepage links to every main service.

THE FIX
Add a booking button at the top and bottom of each service page, plus a short “Related” line with 1 or 2 links.

Google lists “making your content easily findable through internal links” among the basics that still apply to its AI features.

PILLAR 3 OF 4

AI & Search Optimization

When someone asks AI, are you the answer? 20 points

9 AI names you when asked for the best near you

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

The core test: when a customer asks an AI assistant for a recommendation, are you in the answer?

TEST IT: Open a new chat in ChatGPT, Gemini and Perplexity (use a private window if you can) and paste:

> **I just moved to YOUR TOWN. Who are the best YOUR SERVICE (for example dog groomers, vets or dog trainers) near me, and why?**

Ask each one twice; answers vary.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
You're named by at least 2 of the 3 tools. Named by 1 counts as Partly.

THE FIX
This score rises as the rest of this checklist improves, especially reviews, your Google profile and other sites mentioning you. Write down who AI named instead of you: that's your real competition.

10 AI describes you correctly

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Being mentioned isn't enough. AI has to get your services, location and reputation right.

TEST IT: In the same tools, paste:

> **What do you know about YOUR BUSINESS NAME in YOUR TOWN? What services do they offer, where are they, what are their hours, and what do customers say?**

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Your services, town, hours and contact details are right, and the review summary is fair. Wrong details, a mix-up with another business, or "I don't have information" counts as No.

THE FIX
Make your business name, services, address and hours identical on your website, Google profile and main directories, and add a clear About paragraph to your homepage: who you are, what you do, where, and since when.

11 Your first two sentences say what you do and where

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

AI tools quote short passages. Pages that answer up front are the easiest to quote.

TEST IT: Open your homepage and your top service page. Read only the first two sentences under the headline.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
They say what you do, who it's for and where. Weak: "Welcome! We're so glad you found us." Strong: "We're a dog grooming salon in Frisco, Colorado, offering full grooms, baths and nail trims for all breeds. Most appointments take 2 to 3 hours."

THE FIX
Rewrite the opening of your homepage and each service page so it starts with the answer. Keep the warm welcome, just move it after.

12 You have a real FAQ

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

People now type full questions into search and AI. A good FAQ answers them in your words.

TEST IT: Find your FAQ section (on its own page or on service pages) and count the questions.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
5 or more questions in your customers' words, each answered in 1 to 3 sentences that start with the answer: "Yes, we take dogs of all sizes" or "A full groom is $65 to $110, depending on size and coat."

THE FIX
List the 5 questions your front desk or inbox gets most, answer each in plain language, and put them on your site.

PILLAR 4 OF 4

Local & Trust Signals

Do Google and AI trust you enough to recommend you? 40 points

This pillar counts double. For a local business, trust is what turns being found into being chosen.

13 Your Google Business Profile is claimed and complete

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Your Google profile feeds Google Maps and Google's AI answers, and other AI tools read it too.

TEST IT: Search your business name on Google and look at your profile. Is there an "Own this business?" link (not claimed)? Check hours (including holidays), website, phone, description, services, booking link and service area.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Claimed, with every field filled in and accurate.

THE FIX
Sign in at business.google.com, fill in every field, and write the description in plain language with your main services and town.

Google lists keeping your "Business Profile information up-to-date" among the basics for its AI features.

14 Your Google Business Profile category is the right one

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Your primary category tells Google which searches you're relevant for, and relevance is one of the three things Google says local results depend on.

TEST IT: Search your business in Google Maps and look at the category under your name. Compare it to the top 3 businesses for your main search.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
It matches the service you most want to be found for, the way customers search (Veterinarian, Pet groomer, Dog trainer, Dog day care center, Pet boarding service), with secondary categories for your other real services.

THE FIX
Change it in your profile. Only pick categories for services you actually offer.

15 Your review count keeps up with the top 3

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Google says review count and rating factor into local ranking, and AI tools summarize your reviews for shoppers.

TEST IT: Search **YOUR SERVICE near YOUR TOWN** in Google Maps. Write down the review counts of the top 3, then compare yours.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
You have at least as many reviews as the #3 business. At least half as many counts as Partly.

THE FIX
Ask every happy customer the same day with a direct review link (a QR card at the front desk, a line in your follow-up text or email). Never buy reviews or only ask the happy ones; both break Google's rules.

Google: "More reviews and positive ratings can improve your business' local ranking."

16 A strong rating, with a review in the last 30 days

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Shoppers trust recent reviews, and so do the tools that summarize them.

TEST IT: On your Google profile, check your star rating, then sort reviews by Newest.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
4.5 stars or higher, and at least one new review in the last 30 days.

THE FIX
Make review requests a habit, not a campaign: a few a week beats fifty once a year.

BrightLocal (2026): 74% of consumers only care about reviews written in the last three months.

Local & Trust Signals

Do Google and AI trust you enough to recommend you? 40 points

17 You reply to every review

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Replies show you're paying attention, and they add fresh, specific detail about your services.

TEST IT: Open your 10 newest Google reviews. Count how many have a reply from you.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Every review from the last 90 days has a reply, including the tough ones. The best replies are personal: “Thanks for trusting us with Max's first groom.”

THE FIX
Block 10 minutes a week to reply. Thank the happy ones; answer the unhappy ones calmly and take the details offline.

18 New photos and a post in the last 30 days

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

An active profile looks open and trustworthy. A stale one looks closed.

TEST IT: On your Google profile, check the dates on your newest owner photos and your Updates (posts).

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
You added real photos and at least one post (an update, offer or event) in the last 30 days.

THE FIX
Every two weeks, post one real photo (a happy pup, your team, your space) and two sentences. Phone photos are fine.

19 You're in the top 3 on the map for your main search

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

The top 3 map results are what people see first on their phone, before they scroll or ask anything else.

TEST IT: From your phone, near your business, search **YOUR MAIN SERVICE near me** and **YOUR MAIN SERVICE YOUR TOWN** in Google Maps.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
You're in the top 3 for both. Top 3 for one of them counts as Partly. Rankings shift with where the searcher stands, so this is a snapshot.

THE FIX
Everything in this pillar moves it. Google says local results depend mainly on relevance, distance and prominence, and you control the first and last.

20 Trusted sites list you, with matching details

☐ Yes 5 ☐ Partly 2 ☐ No 0 Score: ___

Before recommending you, AI tools cross-check what other sites say about you.

TEST IT: Search your business name and town. Check Yelp, Facebook, Apple Maps, Bing and any pet-industry sites you're on. Then search **best YOUR SERVICE in YOUR TOWN** and look for local best-of lists, awards and articles.

GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Your name, address, phone and website match exactly everywhere, and at least one trusted local or industry source mentions you: a best-of award, a chamber listing, a rescue partner page or local news.

THE FIX
Fix mismatches first. Then go after one new mention each quarter: enter a local best-of award, join your chamber, or offer to be quoted by local media.

Whitespark's 2026 expert survey: the #1 factor for AI search visibility is being on expert-curated “best of” lists, and 3 of the top 5 are citation factors.

Your score and your next step

PILLAR	POINTS POSSIBLE	MY POINTS
Pillar 1: Technical Foundation	20	
Pillar 2: Authority Engine	20	
Pillar 3: AI & Search Optimization	20	
Pillar 4: Local & Trust Signals	40	
Total	**100**	

0 TO 49

Invisible

Google and AI tools have a hard time finding or trusting you, so customers are being sent to someone else. The good news: the biggest wins (usually in Pillar 4) take weeks, not months.

50 TO 74

Findable

You're in the game, but you're not the default answer yet. A handful of fixes usually separates you from the businesses AI names first.

75 TO 100

Unmissable

You've done real work, and it shows. The job now is keeping the lead as the tools change, without it eating your week.

Start here: 5 fixes you can finish this week

Whatever your score, these take an afternoon and cost nothing: **#4** unblock AI crawlers, **#13** complete your Google profile, **#14** fix your primary category, **#17** reply to your recent reviews, **#18** add new photos and a post.

Scored under 75? Get your free AI Visibility Audit.

I check how your business shows up on Google and across AI platforms, score it, and give you the top fixes in priority order. Delivered by a human, not a bot. You keep the plan either way.

Request it at pawandprosper.com/free-audit

Scored 75 or higher and want help keeping the lead?

I'm offering 2 Founding Client spots: done-for-you visibility work at a founding rate, in exchange for an honest testimonial and permission to share results. If we work together, you'll see measurable improvement in your Google and AI visibility within 90 days, or I keep working at no extra cost until we hit the benchmarks we set together.

Book a 30-minute call

About me



I'm Samantha Quinones, founder of Paw & Prosper. I help vets, groomers, trainers, boarding and daycare businesses, pet brands and rescues get found on Google and recommended by AI.

I have over 12 years in digital marketing, and every client works with me directly, from the first audit to the monthly report. I'm based in Summit County, Colorado, with a Lab-Collie mix named Itachi who supervises.

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32x
growth in Google impressions in six months for Lone Star Animal Welfare League, with no ad spend

#1
2026 Best of Summit, Customer Service

5.0
stars on Google

How I built this checklist

These 20 checks are a simplified, do-it-yourself version of the Unmissable Index, the four-pillar scoring framework I use in every paid audit. I cross-checked every check against what Google and OpenAI publish about their own tools, and against independent industry research:

1. Google Search Central, "AI features and your website" (last updated Dec 10, 2025) developers.google.com/search
2. Google Business Profile Help, "How to improve your local ranking on Google" support.google.com/business/answer/7091
3. OpenAI, "Overview of OpenAI Crawlers" developers.openai.com/api/docs/bots
4. Whitespark, Local Search Ranking Factors, 2026 edition (survey of 47 local search experts) whitespark.ca/local-search-ranking-factors
5. BrightLocal, Local Consumer Review Survey 2026 (1,002 US consumers, Feb 2026) brightlocal.com/research/local-consumer-review-survey

These are signals search engines and AI tools are known to use, not a guaranteed formula. No one outside the AI companies knows exactly how they choose, and the tools change often. The fundamentals here (be easy to find, easy to read, and easy to trust) have held up through every change so far.

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